



Air Quality Situation Report

Edmonton Folk Music Festival ·
Gallagher Park

Sat, Aug 1, 2026 · 10:42 PM MDT
For more information, contact Gary Redmond, ACA Executive Director at 780.935.4279

Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) — Edmonton

4.0

Current AQHI at Edmonton McCauley (1.66 km from venue)
Forecast Sun 12:00 AM: **2.9**

Health Risk	AQHI	At-Risk Population	General Population
Moderate Risk	4.0	Consider reducing or rescheduling strenuous activities outdoors if you are experiencing symptoms.	No need to modify your usual outdoor activities unless you experience symptoms such as coughing and throat irritation.

Active Environment Canada Alerts

Severe Thunderstorm Watch — City of Edmonton - St. Albert - Sherwood Park
Wind Warning — City of Edmonton - St. Albert - Sherwood Park

Environmental Intelligence Summary

- At Edmonton Folk Music Festival, temperature is 20.7°C and feels near 21.6°C. Winds are 13 km/h from NW, gusting near 27 km/h.
- Environment Canada has 2 active alert(s) in effect for the venue: severe thunderstorm watch, wind warning.
- The nearest current AQHI is 4 at Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km from the venue.
- The official Government of Alberta AQHI for Edmonton is 5 (forecast tonight: 5, tomorrow: 3).
- A gridded AQHI estimate blending official and community sensors (confidence: High) puts the area near 4.
- The nearest air monitoring station (Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km) reports fine particulate matter (PM2.5) at 34.3 µg/m³.
- An on-site community sensor ('ACA_CloverdaleCL', 0.5 km) reads 46.7 µg/m³ PM2.5.
- Back-trajectory modeling (HRDPS wind fields, 6 h lookback) indicates the air currently at the venue traveled from the vicinity of a point 51.2 km to the SW, i.e. arriving from the SW.
- The nearest active fire detection (NASA FIRMS – VIIRS, last 2026-08-01) is 6.0 km E of the venue. The modeled back-trajectory passes within 6.0 km of this fire, making smoke transport to the venue plausible based on wind-field modeling.
- The AQHI forecast for Sun 12:00 AM is 3.
- Thunderstorm conditions appear in the hourly forecast beginning around Sun 12:00 AM.
- Overall operational environmental risk is HIGH. Primary concerns are wind, precipitation, thunderstorm.

Recommendations

- Confirm lightning monitoring, shelter, pause and evacuation procedures.
- Review temporary structures, signage and stage wind limits.
- Prepare drainage, electrical protection and wet-weather controls.
- Active Environment Canada alert(s) for the venue — review details: severe thunderstorm watch, wind warning.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — general population: No need to modify your usual outdoor activities unless you experience symptoms such as coughing and throat irritation.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — at-risk populations: Consider reducing or rescheduling strenuous activities outdoors if you are experiencing symptoms.

Hazard Snapshot — Overall Risk: High Risk

AIR QUALITY Moderate Risk 4.0 AQHI	HEAT Low Risk 26.4 °C apparent/humidex	WIND High Risk 77.4 km/h peak gust	PRECIPITATION High Risk 5.9 mm/h maximum	THUNDERSTORM High Risk Sun 12:00 AM first forecast signal
WIND SHEAR Low Risk 1.7 ° direction diff (10m vs 120m)				

Local Monitoring

Nearest station 4.0 Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	Blended estimate 4.0 confidence High	PM2.5 (station) 34.3 µg/m³ Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	PM2.5 (community) 46.7 µg/m³ ACA_CloverdaleCL · 0.45 km
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Prepared by Alberta Capital Airshed for the Edmonton Folk Music Festival. Beta decision-support product — for the interactive map, live cameras and hourly outlook, scan the QR code or visit https://dkevinm.github.io/environmental_intelligence_edmonton/

